Pragathi Akula

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EDUCATION

University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill, Chapel Hill, NC — Expected May 2030
Biostatistics major with a minor in Medicine, Literature, and Culture, ***GPA:*** *In Progress*
Relevant Coursework: ENG105: Writing in Health and Medicine, ANTH147: Comparative Healing Systems
Awards: National Merit Truist Scholarship Recipient

The North Carolina School of Science and Mathematics, Durham, NC
High School Diploma, ***GPA:*** *4.91* — 2026
Awards: Bowman-Brockman Research Endowment Recipient, Student Ambassador for the Office of Admissions

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

UNC Department of Cell Biology and Physiology, *Undergraduate Intern*, Chapel Hill, NC — Sept 2026 - Present
- Shadowing operations in The Snider Lab, which studies the causal link between intermediate filament protein mutations and disease mechanisms
- Assist in software development and data verification for GFAP Atlas, a web-based computational platform designed to aggregate mutation data, integrate datasets describing GFAP biology, and model protein behavior.

UNC Hospitals, Chapel Hill, NC — August 2026 - Present
- Observe specialized nursing and cardiology operations within the heart transplant clinic, gaining direct insight into interdisciplinary care coordination and hospital workflows.
- Observe heart catheterization procedures and engage in technical discussions with cardiologists, analyzing the mechanical and physiological principles of invasive cardiac intervention.

Shakti Dance Academy, *Student Graduate and Teaching Assistant*, Charlotte, NC — 2015 - Present
- Earned official certification upon completing the Arangetram, a two-hour solo debut performance representing 10+ years of rigorous technical training in Bharatanatyam.
- Direct weekly instructional sessions for 15 beginner students, designing technical drills and promoting cross-cultural appreciation among young artists.
- Perform as a featured dancer at major regional cultural events, including the Festival of India and Charlotte Tamil Sangam, showcasing classical Indian arts to diverse audiences.

LEADERSHIP & COMMUNITY INVOLVEMENT

UNC Ek Taal, *Competitive Dance Team Member*, Chapel Hill, NC — August 2026 - Present
- Dedicate ~7 hours weekly to team training and routine rehearsals, competing nationally against top collegiate Indian classical dance teams.
- Fundraise for team travel expenses by coordinating and volunteering at university athletic events, directly offsetting competition costs.

Youth Movement Against Alzheimer's at UNC Chapel Hill, *Member*, Chapel Hill, NC — August 2026 - Present
- Assist in community relief efforts, organizing targeted care packages and volunteer operations for local eldercare facilities.
- Completed formal emergency training in Naloxone (Narcan) Administration and Overdose Harm Reduction via the UNC Student Health Action Coalition to advocate for public health and opioid crisis intervention.

SKILLS AND INTERESTS

- *Certifications:* Basic Life Support (BLS): CPR and AED - American Heart Association (Issued March 2026, Expires March 2028) | Emergency Medical Technician (EMT) - NCOEMS (Expires July 2030) |
- *Language Skills:* English (Fluent) | Spanish (Conversational) | Tamil (Basics) |
- *Interests:* Pediatrics | Cardiology | Classical dance | Teaching/Tutoring